KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 5: CHARTING THE COURSE · WEEK 21 · READING

Homes in the Canyon Walls — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students identify five text structures in informational text (chronology, cause and effect, problem and solution, compare and contrast, and description), use signal words as evidence for a structure, recognize when one text mixes two structures, compare how two texts organize facts about the same people, and write a summary that follows the structure of the text.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: Yesenia Zamora and her younger brother, Zane, have just visited Mesa Verde National Park in southwestern Colorado, where Ancestral Pueblo people lived for about 700 years, and they are writing a report for their homeschool co-op. The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Unit 4 Review (8 pts, 4 each): summary and theme (Week 19), and narrator versus speaker.
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W21.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: How Is This Text Built? Five text structures and their signal words. Stress: signal words are clues, not proof; ask what the WHOLE text is mostly doing, and name both structures when a text mixes them.
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 6 flip cards (text structure, signal words, chronology, archeologist, alcove, migrate).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Text A: From Pithouses to Cliff Dwellings (5 pts). An original article in time order (At first, Later, Then, Finally): pithouses, mesa-top pueblos around 1000 CE, cliff dwellings in the late 1190s (Cliff Palace had about 150 rooms and 23 kivas), and the move south by about 1300. Use the paragraph numbers.
8. Slide 7 — Text B: Living With Little Water (5 pts). The same people, built as problem and solution (scarce water; seep springs and reservoirs), then cause and effect (a long drought in the last 25 years of the 1200s; families migrated south, where their descendants still live).
9. Slide 8 — Same People, Different Structures (10 pts, 5 each): name the structure of new short passages and find the signal word that proves it.
10. Slide 9 — Teach: Summarize by Structure. Name the structure, pick the matching frame (First... later... finally...; Because... as a result...; The problem was... people solved it by...; Both... but...; The topic is... its main features are...), keep only the big ideas, then cut and check: own words, no opinions, no copying 4 or more words in a row. Compare the weak and strong summaries of Text B.

11. Slide 10 — Structure Detective (12 pts, 6 each): pick the strongest summary or frame, spot details that are too small, and catch the mistakes.
12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules. A sentence that starts with Because needs a comma after the whole “because” part.
14. Slide 13 — Back It Up With Evidence (4 pts): quote the sentence that proves the structure, starting with the tag shown, a comma, and the exact words in quotation marks with the end mark inside. Checked exactly.
15. Slide 14 — Writer’s Turn: Summarize by Structure (6 pts): one typed answer auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (allowed names count as one word); and every key idea included. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): text structures, signal words or Mesa Verde words matched to their meanings (a different set each attempt), 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick questions against the student’s own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items across both texts (name the structure, then check the evidence or the summary).
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W21.pdf), including the writing item and the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Structure Found!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows “Structure Spotter!” with the congratulations message “Structure spotter! You found the skeleton hiding inside every text!” and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows “Keep Going!” with encouragement (“You’re getting closer, and every try makes you stronger.”), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: UNIT 4 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
`rv1_s0`	Set 1: Find the mistake! Zion summarized Aesop’s fable “The Tortoise and the Hare”: The Hare brags that he is faster and races the Tortoise. I think the Hare is rude and silly. The Tortoise keeps going slowly and wins. What is the BIGGEST problem? [It includes Zion’s opinion, and a summary leaves opinions out. / It tells the events in the order they happen. / It is written in Zion’s own words. / It names both main characters.]	**It includes Zion’s opinion, and a summary leaves opinions out.**	“I think the Hare is rude and silly” is Zion’s opinion. A summary leaves opinions out (Week 19). The other choices describe things a summary SHOULD do: tell events in order, use your own words, and name the main characters.
`rv2_s0`	Set 1: Type your answer: a summary tells WHAT happens. The full-sentence message about life that those events show is called the ___.	**theme** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	A summary tells what happens. The message about life those events show is the theme (Week 19).

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv1_s1	Set 2: Read: Yolanda's robotics team kept losing because everyone argued over whose idea was best. When they finally combined their ideas, their robot won second place. Which sentence states the THEME? [People can accomplish more when they combine their ideas than when they compete. / Robots / Yolanda's robot won second place. / Stop arguing with your team.]	**People can accomplish more when they combine their ideas than when they compete.**	A theme is a full-sentence message about life that fits beyond this one story. "Robots" is only a topic, "Yolanda's robot won second place" is an event from the story, and "Stop arguing with your team" is a command (Week 19).
rv2_s1	Set 2: Type the missing word: a summary must be written in your ___ words, without copying 4 or more words in a row from the text.	**own**	A summary must be in your own words. Copying 4 or more words in a row is not summarizing (Week 19).
rv1_s2	Set 3: In "The Tortoise and the Hare," the Hare brags that he is fastest, the Hare has long ears, the Hare races ahead and takes a nap, and the Tortoise passes him and wins. Which detail is too small to belong in a summary? [The Hare has long ears. / The Hare brags that he is fastest. / The Hare races ahead and takes a nap. / The Tortoise passes the Hare and wins.]	**The Hare has long ears.**	The Hare's long ears do not change what happens, so that detail is too small for a summary. The bragging, the nap, and the Tortoise winning are the key events (Week 19).
rv2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: in a story, the voice telling it is the narrator. In a POEM, the voice that is talking is called the ___.	**speaker** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	The voice talking in a poem is the speaker. In a story, that voice is the narrator (Week 19).

YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s0	Set 1: From Text B: "Many cliff dwellings were built near seep springs, places where water slowly trickles out of the rock." Using the context, what is a seep spring? [A place where water slowly leaks out of rock / A tall waterfall that pours over a cliff / A metal coil that bounces back / A season when snow melts]	**A place where water slowly leaks out of rock**	The sentence defines it right after the comma: "places where water slowly trickles out of the rock." A seep spring is a spot where water leaks slowly from rock.
v2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: the way a writer organizes the ideas in a text, such as time order or problem and solution, is called the text ___.	**structure** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	The way a writer organizes ideas is the text structure.
v1_s1	Set 2: Which word means "to move from one region to another to live"? [migrate / harvest / describe / organize]	**migrate**	To migrate is to move from one region to another to live, as the families of Mesa Verde did when they moved south around 1300.
v2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: words like first, because, however, and as a result point to a text structure. They are called ___ words.	**signal** (also accepted: transition, clue; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Words like first, because, however, and as a result are signal words. They point to the text structure.
v1_s2	Set 3: From Text A: "Families reached their fields by climbing hand-and-toe-hold trails pecked into the canyon walls." Using the context, what does pecked most likely mean here? [Chipped out with small, repeated hits of a hard tool / Made by birds tapping with their beaks / Painted on with colored clay / Covered with soft mud]	**Chipped out with small, repeated hits of a hard tool**	People made the trails by chipping small holds into the rock, one hit at a time. Here pecked means chipped out with small, repeated blows of a hard tool, not anything birds did.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a scientist who studies the objects and places people left behind long ago is called an ___.	**archeologist** (also accepted: archaeologist; with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	An archeologist (also spelled archaeologist) studies the objects and places people left behind to learn about the past.

TEXT A: FROM PITHOUSES TO CLIFF DWELLINGS (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Text A tells the stages of Ancestral Pueblo life in the order they happened. What is the name of this text structure?	**chronology** (also accepted: chronological, sequence, time order, time-order, timeline, time line)	Text A walks through time, from pithouses to pueblos to cliff dwellings to the move south, with signal words like At first, Later, Then, and Finally. That structure is chronology, or time order.
sa_s1	Set 2: Two steps: follow the signal words At first, Later, Then, Finally. Which list puts the stages in the order Text A gives them? [Pithouses → stone villages on the mesa tops → cliff dwellings → migrating south / Cliff dwellings → pithouses → stone villages on the mesa tops → migrating south / Stone villages on the mesa tops → migrating south → pithouses → cliff dwellings / Pithouses → cliff dwellings → migrating south → stone villages on the mesa tops]	**Pithouses → stone villages on the mesa tops → cliff dwellings → migrating south**	Paragraph 2 (At first) describes pithouses, paragraph 3 (Later) describes mesa-top pueblos, paragraph 4 (Then) describes the cliff dwellings, and paragraph 5 (Finally) tells of the move south.
sa_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: according to paragraph 5, families lived in the cliff dwellings for less than how many years?	**100** (also accepted: one hundred, hundred; with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	Paragraph 5 says, “They had lived in the cliff dwellings for less than 100 years.”

TEXT B: LIVING WITH LITTLE WATER (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sb_s0	Set 1: Two steps: in paragraphs 1 and 2, what PROBLEM do the people face, AND what is one SOLUTION? [Problem: too little water. Solution: building homes near seep springs. / Problem: too many visitors. Solution: building tall stone walls. / Problem: cold winters. Solution: weaving baskets. / Problem: a long drought. Solution: moving south.]	**Problem: too little water. Solution: building homes near seep springs.**	Paragraph 1 names the problem: little water. Paragraph 2 gives solutions, including building near seep springs and building reservoirs. The drought is a later cause in paragraph 3, and moving south is an effect, not a solution from paragraphs 1 and 2.
sb_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: paragraph 3 says that because rain and snow were scarce, ___ failed. (one word)	**crops** (also accepted: crop, the crops)	Paragraph 3 says, “Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed.” The scarce rain and snow are the cause; the failed crops are an effect.
sb_s2	Set 3: Paragraph 4 begins with “As a result.” Which explanation of why the author uses this phrase is correct? [It signals that what follows is an effect of the drought described in paragraph 3. / It signals that two villages are about to be compared. / It signals the first stage in a timeline. / It signals a list of features of a kiva.]	**It signals that what follows is an effect of the drought described in paragraph 3.**	“As a result” is a cause-and-effect signal. It tells the reader that the hard choices and the move are effects of the drought and the other causes described just before.

SAME PEOPLE, DIFFERENT STRUCTURES (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp1_s0	Set 1: Read: A pithouse and a cliff dwelling were both homes for Ancestral Pueblo families. However, a pithouse was built partly below the ground on the mesa top, while a cliff dwelling was built of stone inside an alcove. Which structure does this passage use? [Compare and contrast / Chronology / Problem and solution / Cause and effect]	**Compare and contrast**	The passage tells how the two homes are alike (both were homes) and how they are different (one was dug into the ground, one was built in an alcove). Both, however, and while are compare-and-contrast signal words.
qp2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: two steps. In that same passage, find the signal word that STARTS a sentence and shows a difference is coming.	**however**	"However" begins the second sentence and signals that a difference is coming. ("While" also shows contrast, but it does not start a sentence.)
qp1_s1	Set 2: Read: Most kivas at Mesa Verde were round rooms. Many had a fire pit in the floor, a low bench around the wall, and a shaft that brought in fresh air. Which structure does this passage use? [Description / Chronology / Compare and contrast / Cause and effect]	**Description**	The passage does not tell events in order, explain a cause, or solve a problem. It lists the features of one topic, kivas, so it is description.
qp2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: two steps. Look back at Text A. Paragraph 3 begins with one signal word that moves the timeline forward. Type that word.	**later**	Paragraph 3 of Text A begins, "Later, around 1000 CE..." The word Later moves the timeline forward.
qp1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Zane says Text A is compare and contrast "because it talks about pithouses AND cliff dwellings." Which explanation is correct? [He is wrong. Text A names both homes, but it is organized by time, with signal words like At first, Later, Then, and Finally. / He is right. Any text that names two things is compare and contrast. / He is wrong. Text A is problem and solution because it mentions water. / He is wrong. Text A has no structure at all.]	**He is wrong. Text A names both homes, but it is organized by time, with signal words like At first, Later, Then, and Finally.**	Naming two kinds of homes does not make a text compare and contrast. Text A is organized by time: each paragraph starts with a time signal (At first, Later, Then, Finally) and moves to the next stage.
qp2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: two steps. Read: Because the drought lasted for years, the reservoirs held less water. Type the signal word that introduces the CAUSE.	**because** (also accepted: since)	"Because" introduces the cause (the long drought). The effect is that the reservoirs held less water.

STRUCTURE DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s0	Set 1: Which is the BEST summary of Text A? [Ancestral Pueblo families first lived in pithouses, later built stone villages on the mesa tops, and then built homes in the cliff alcoves. By about 1300, they had moved south, where their descendants live today. / Cliff Palace had about 150 rooms and 23 kivas. Mesa Verde means “green table” in Spanish. / The cliff dwellings are the coolest houses ever built, and I want to live in one. / Ancestral Pueblo families first built cliff dwellings, then moved into pithouses, and finally built stone villages.]	**Ancestral Pueblo families first lived in pithouses, later built stone villages on the mesa tops, and then built homes in the cliff alcoves. By about 1300, they had moved south, where their descendants live today.**	The best summary follows Text A’s timeline: pithouses, mesa-top villages, cliff dwellings, then the move south, in new words. The others list small details, give an opinion, or put the stages in the wrong order.
d2_s0	Set 1: Find the mistake! Yolanda summarized Text B: First, Mesa Verde is dry. Second, there were springs. Third, wood samples exist. Fourth, people moved. What is the BIGGEST problem? [She used a “first, second, third” list, so she lost the causes and effects. She never says the drought made crops fail and helped lead people to move. / She used her own words instead of copying. / She mentioned that Mesa Verde is dry, which is not in Text B. / A summary should never mention people moving.]	**She used a “first, second, third” list, so she lost the causes and effects. She never says the drought made crops fail and helped lead people to move.**	Text B explains WHY things happened. Yolanda’s numbered list drops the connections: it never says the drought made crops fail or that it helped lead families to move. The cause-and-effect frame would keep those links.
d1_s1	Set 2: Which summary frame fits Text B best? [The problem was ___. People solved it by ___. Then, because ___, ___ happened. / Both ___ and ___ are alike because ___, but they differ because ___. / The topic is ___. Its features are ___, ___, and ___. / Once upon a time, ___. They lived happily ever after.]	**The problem was ___. People solved it by ___. Then, because ___, ___ happened.**	Text B begins with a problem and solutions, then a cause and its effects, so this frame matches it. “Both… but…” is for compare and contrast, a feature list is for description, and a fairy-tale opening is for fiction.
d2_s1	Set 2: Zion says, “A text can only have ONE structure.” Which explanation is correct? [No. Text B gives a problem and solutions in paragraphs 1–2, then causes and effects in paragraphs 3–4. Writers can mix structures. / Yes. Every text uses exactly one structure from beginning to end. / No. Every text uses all five structures in every paragraph. / Yes. Only fiction can mix structures.]	**No. Text B gives a problem and solutions in paragraphs 1–2, then causes and effects in paragraphs 3–4. Writers can mix structures.**	Text B shows that writers can mix structures: paragraphs 1–2 give a problem and solutions, and paragraphs 3–4 explain causes and effects. One structure may lead, but a text does not have to use only one.
d1_s2	Set 3: Which detail is too small to belong in a summary of Text A? [“Mesa Verde” means “green table” in Spanish. / Early families lived in pithouses on the mesa tops. / In the late 1190s, many families moved into cliff alcoves. / By about 1300, families had migrated south.]	**“Mesa Verde” means “green table” in Spanish.**	The meaning of the name “Mesa Verde” is an interesting fact, but it is not one of the stages on Text A’s timeline. The other three are the main stages, so they belong in the summary.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d2_s2	Set 3: Which sentence would BEST begin a summary of Text B? [The Ancestral Pueblo people of Mesa Verde faced a constant problem: there was very little water. / The cliff dwellings were built from sandstone, mortar, and wooden beams. / I would not like to live somewhere without much water. / In 1906, Mesa Verde became a national park.]	**The Ancestral Pueblo people of Mesa Verde faced a constant problem: there was very little water.**	Text B opens with the problem of scarce water, so a summary of it should open the same way. The building materials come from Text A, the 1906 date is not in Text B, and "I would not like..." is an opinion.

FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs1_s0	Set 1: Comma after an introductory time phrase: add the missing comma. In the late 1190s many families moved into alcoves.	**In the late 1190s, many families moved into alcoves.**	A time phrase like "In the late 1190s" that starts a sentence is followed by a comma.
fs2_s0	Set 1: Cause and effect with so: add the missing comma. Rain was scarce so the crops failed.	**Rain was scarce, so the crops failed.**	"Rain was scarce" and "the crops failed" are both complete sentences. When "so" joins them, a comma goes before "so."
fs3_s0	Set 1: Comma after an introductory signal word: add the missing comma. However the reservoirs became less reliable.	**However, the reservoirs became less reliable.**	Put a comma after an introductory signal word like "However."
fs4_s0	Set 1: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. The cliff dwellings at Mesa Verde was built from sandstone.	**The cliff dwellings at Mesa Verde were built from sandstone.**	The subject is "dwellings," which is plural, so the verb must be "were," not "was." The words "at Mesa Verde" do not change the subject.
fs1_s1	Set 2: Capital letters: fix the five capital-letter mistakes. the hopi and zuni people are descendants of the ancestral pueblo people.	**The Hopi and Zuni people are descendants of the Ancestral Pueblo people.**	Capitalize the first word of the sentence and the names of nations and peoples: The, Hopi, Zuni, Ancestral, and Pueblo.
fs2_s1	Set 2: Comma after an introductory signal phrase: add the missing comma. As a result families moved south.	**As a result, families moved south.**	Put a comma after an introductory signal phrase like "As a result."
fs3_s1	Set 2: Comma after an introductory "because" part: add the missing comma. Because rain was scarce the crops failed.	**Because rain was scarce, the crops failed.**	When a sentence starts with a "because" part, put a comma after that whole part, before the main idea.
fs4_s1	Set 2: Grammar: fix the its / it's mistake. Each kiva had it's own fire pit.	**Each kiva had its own fire pit.**	"It's" means "it is." The fire pit belongs to the kiva, so use the possessive "its" with no apostrophe.
fs1_s2	Set 3: Commas in a series: add the commas between the three crops. Families grew corn beans and squash.	**Families grew corn, beans, and squash.** (also accepted: Families grew corn, beans and squash.)	Use commas to separate the three crops in a series: corn, beans, and squash.
fs2_s2	Set 3: City and state: add the TWO missing commas. The family drove from Cortez Colorado to the park.	**The family drove from Cortez, Colorado, to the park.**	Put a comma between a city and its state, and another comma after the state when the sentence keeps going.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs3_s2	Set 3: Commas after introductory words: add the TWO missing commas. Finally by about 1300 the families had migrated south.	**Finally, by about 1300, the families had migrated south.**	“Finally” and “by about 1300” both come before the main idea, so each one is followed by a comma.
fs4_s2	Set 3: Grammar: fix the their / there / they’re mistake. The farmers carried there harvest up the cliff.	**The farmers carried their harvest up the cliff.**	The harvest belongs to the farmers, so use the possessive “their,” not “there.”

BACK IT UP WITH EVIDENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s0	Set 1: This sentence proves that Text B uses cause and effect. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text B, paragraph 3): Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed, and the mesa-top reservoirs became less reliable. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed, and the mesa-top reservoirs became less reliable."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word (including both commas and the hyphen in mesa-top) inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s1	Set 2: This sentence proves that Text A uses chronology. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 4): Then, in the late 1190s, many families moved into alcoves, shallow caves under the overhanging canyon walls. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "Then, in the late 1190s, many families moved into alcoves, shallow caves under the overhanging canyon walls."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and all three commas inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s2	Set 3: This sentence proves that Text B names a problem. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text B, paragraph 1): Finding enough water was one of the biggest challenges of daily life. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "Finding enough water was one of the biggest challenges of daily life."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word inside quotation marks, with the period inside the closing quotation mark.

WRITER'S TURN: SUMMARIZE BY STRUCTURE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s0	Set 1: Summarize ALL of Text A in one or two sentences, in your own words. Use a time-order frame (first... later... finally...). Text A, key lines: At first, families lived on the mesa tops in pithouses... Later, around 1000 CE, people began building pueblos, or villages, on the mesa tops... Then, in the late 1190s, many families moved into alcoves... Finally, by about 1300, families had left Mesa Verde and migrated south... Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Names like Mesa Verde and Ancestral Pueblo are fine to keep.) Include the first stage: pithouses. Include the second stage: stone villages (pueblos) on the mesa. Include the third stage: homes in the cliffs or alcoves. Include the last stage: people migrated or moved south. Original: "Mesa Verde means green table in Spanish. It is a high, flat-topped land in southwestern Colorado, cut by deep canyons. For about 700 years, from around 600 to 1300 CE, Ancestral Pueblo people made their homes here. CE stands for Common ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** Ancestral Pueblo families began in pithouses, next built stone villages on top of the mesa, then made homes inside cliff alcoves, and by 1300 they had moved south.	A strong chronology summary keeps the four stages in order, in new words: pithouses, stone villages on the mesa, cliff homes, and the move south. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: pithouse or pit house or pit; pueblo or village or stone or mesa; cliff or alcove or canyon; migrat or moved south or left or leav or south.
wt_s1	Set 2: Summarize paragraphs 1 and 2 of Text B in one or two sentences, in your own words. Use a problem-and-solution frame. Text B, paragraphs 1–2: Mesa Verde is a dry place... Finding enough water was one of the biggest challenges of daily life. People solved this problem in several ways. Many cliff dwellings were built near seep springs... Communities also built reservoirs on the mesa tops to store water. Use at least 15 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Single words like springs and reservoirs are fine to keep.) Name what was hard to find: water. State the problem: the land was dry or water was scarce. Give solution 1: building near springs. Give solution 2: storing water in reservoirs. Original: "Mesa Verde is a dry place. Farmers there depended on rain and melting snow for their crops, and the area had few water sources that lasted all year. Finding enough water was one of the biggest challenges of daily life. People solved this problem in several ways. Many cliff dwellings were built near seep springs, places where water slowly trickles out of the rock. Most archeologists think that being close to water was a main reason people built in the alcoves. Communities also built reservoirs on the mesa tops to store water."	**Sample:** At Mesa Verde, water was hard to find, so people solved the problem by building homes beside springs in the rock and by storing rain in mesa-top reservoirs.	A strong problem-and-solution summary states the problem (scarce water) and both solutions (living near springs and storing water in reservoirs), in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 15 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: water; dry or scarce or little or few or lack or short or not enough or hard to find or problem; spring or seep; reservoir or stor or save or saving or collect.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s2	Set 3: Summarize paragraphs 3 and 4 of Text B in one or two sentences, in your own words. Use a cause-and-effect frame. Text B, paragraphs 3–4: In the last 25 years of the 1200s, however, a long drought struck. Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed... As a result, families had to make hard choices... They migrated south and built new communities, where their descendants still live. Use at least 15 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. Name the cause: the drought. Name one effect: the crops failed. Name the final effect: people moved south. Use a cause-and-effect signal word such as because, so, or as a result. Original: “In the last 25 years of the 1200s, however, a long drought struck. Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed, and the mesa-top reservoirs became less reliable. Scientists know about these dry years because the growth rings in old wood samples show them. As a result, families had to make hard choices. Archeologists think the drought, worn-out farmland, and problems between communities may all have led people to move. The people did not vanish. They migrated south and built new communities, where their descendants still live.”	**Sample:** A long dry spell in the late 1200s made the harvests fail, so families, also facing tired soil and conflicts, chose to move south and start new towns.	A strong cause-and-effect summary names the cause (the drought), its effects (failed crops and the move south), and links them with a signal word, all in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 15 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original; must include: drought or dry; crop or farm or harvest or food or plant; migrat or moved or move or left or leav or south; because or so or result or caus or led or lead or therefore or since.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match chronology	**events told in time order**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match cause and effect	**why something happened and its result**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match problem and solution	**a challenge and how people met it**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match compare and contrast	**how things are alike and different**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match description	**the features and examples of one topic**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match signal words	**words that point to a text structure**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match however	**a signal word for a difference**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match as a result	**a signal phrase for an effect**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match finally	**a signal word for the last step in time**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match for example	**a signal phrase that adds a detail**	2 points if matched on the first try.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match alcove	**a shallow cave in a cliff wall**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match migrate	**to move to a new region to live**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match kiva	**a room for ceremonies and gatherings**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match pithouse	**a home built partly below the ground**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match reservoir	**a place built to store water**	2 points if matched on the first try.

BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, name the structure of Text B, paragraphs 3–4. Step 2, choose evidence from THOSE paragraphs. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Cause and effect. Evidence: "Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed." / Cause and effect. Evidence: "At first, families lived on the mesa tops in pithouses." / Chronology. Evidence: "Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed." / Description. Evidence: "Mesa Verde is a dry place."]	**Cause and effect. Evidence: "Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed."**	Paragraphs 3 and 4 of Text B explain a cause (the drought) and its effects (failed crops, the move), and the "Because..." sentence proves it. The pithouse sentence comes from Text A, the structure "chronology" is wrong for these paragraphs, and "Mesa Verde is a dry place" is not a description of the whole passage.
b2_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Yesenia wants to write a paragraph showing how pithouses and cliff dwellings were alike AND different. Which structure and signal words should she use? [Compare and contrast, with signal words like both, however, and unlike / Chronology, with signal words like first, then, and finally / Cause and effect, with signal words like because and as a result / Compare and contrast, with signal words like because and so]	**Compare and contrast, with signal words like both, however, and unlike**	Showing how two things are alike AND different is compare and contrast, and its signal words include both, however, and unlike. The other choices pair the wrong structure with her goal or use signal words that do not fit.
b1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation of how Text A and Text B are organized is correct for BOTH texts? [Text A follows time order from pithouses to the move south; Text B moves from a problem and solutions to the causes and effects of a drought. / Text A is problem and solution; Text B is chronology. / Both texts only describe the features of Cliff Palace. / Text A compares two parks; Text B tells a story with a theme.]	**Text A follows time order from pithouses to the move south; Text B moves from a problem and solutions to the causes and effects of a drought.**	Text A follows a timeline from pithouses to the move south. Text B moves from a problem and its solutions to the causes and effects of the drought. The other answers mix up which text does what.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b2_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Zane summarized Text B: Mesa Verde is a really cool place. Cliff Palace has 150 rooms. People moved. Which list names ALL of his problems? [It includes an opinion, it uses a detail from Text A instead of Text B, and it leaves out the water problem, the solutions, and the drought. / It includes an opinion, and nothing else is wrong. / It is in his own words, which is not allowed. / It is too short; a summary should copy every sentence.]	**It includes an opinion, it uses a detail from Text A instead of Text B, and it leaves out the water problem, the solutions, and the drought.**	Zane's summary has three problems: an opinion ("really cool"), a detail from the wrong text (Cliff Palace is in Text A), and missing big ideas (the water problem, the solutions, and the drought that led to the move).
b1_s2	Set 3: Which NEW paragraph uses the SAME structure as Text A? [In 1906, Mesa Verde became a national park. Later, in 1978, it was named a World Heritage Site. Today, visitors from around the world come to learn about it. / Hikers often run low on water. To fix this, the park asks every visitor to carry extra water. / Both trails are steep. However, one trail is shaded, while the other is in full sun. / The pottery had black designs on white clay, such as zigzags, spirals, and stripes.]	**In 1906, Mesa Verde became a national park. Later, in 1978, it was named a World Heritage Site. Today, visitors from around the world come to learn about it.**	The park paragraph moves through dates in time order, just like Text A. The water paragraph is problem and solution, the trail paragraph compares and contrasts, and the pottery paragraph describes.
b2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Yolanda wrote: "Text B proves the drought was the ONLY reason people left Mesa Verde." Which explanation is correct? [She overstates it. Paragraph 4 says the drought, worn-out farmland, and problems between communities "may all have led" people to move. / She is right. Text B names only one cause. / She is wrong because Text B says there was no drought. / She is wrong because Text B says the people vanished.]	**She overstates it. Paragraph 4 says the drought, worn-out farmland, and problems between communities "may all have led" people to move.**	Paragraph 4 says archeologists think "the drought, worn-out farmland, and problems between communities may all have led people to move." The drought was one cause, not the only one, and the word "may" shows that scientists are still studying it.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W21.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: theme of the lion and the mouse	Model: Even small friends can be a big help. (Also good: Kindness is often repaid.) Check that the theme is a full sentence about life, not a word or a plot event.
2	Three words that tell the order	First, Next, Finally
3	Word that usually tells WHY	because
4	One reason to build a home in a cliff wall	Answers vary (for example, to be close to water from springs in the rock, to stay safe, or to find shelter from sun, wind and snow). Text B says most archeologists think being near water was a main reason. Accept any reasonable idea before the lesson.

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
5	Time order, compare or describe a sport?	Answers vary. Look for a clear choice and a reason that matches it (for example, “I would describe its parts, because my friend needs to know the rules and the equipment”).

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Farmers had very little water...: name the structure and a signal phrase	Problem and solution. Signal phrase: “To fix this.” (The problem is very little water; the solutions are reservoirs and homes near springs.)
2	Be the editor	a) In the late 1200s, a long drought struck. b) The Zuni and Hopi people live in New Mexico and Arizona. c) The kivas at Cliff Palace were used for ceremonies.
3	Zane says Text A is cause and effect because it uses Then	He is wrong: Text A is chronology, and one signal word is not proof.
4	Writing: compare a pithouse and a cliff dwelling (4–5 sentences)	Grading note: a likeness and a difference from Text A; uses both and however; a comma after every introductory word or phrase. Model: Both pithouses and cliff dwellings were homes for Ancestral Pueblo families. At first, families lived in pithouses on the mesa tops. A pithouse was built partly below the ground. However, a cliff dwelling was built of sandstone, mortar, and wooden beams inside an alcove. In the late 1190s, many families moved into these cliff homes.

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	The drought facts as chronology, then as cause and effect	Model chronology: In the last 25 years of the 1200s, a long drought struck. Then crops failed. Finally, by about 1300, families moved south. Model cause and effect: Because rain and snow were scarce, crops failed. As a result, families moved south. Check that each version uses its own signal words.